Policy & Strategy Lab

Decision Log

Every design decision is recorded here before any material depends on it. Approved decisions are not changed silently: a change gets a new entry that names the entry it replaces and lists the materials that must be revised.

Status key. Approved: confirmed by the course director. Adopted: set out in the master project brief and treated as approved unless revised. Provisional: the course director left the choice open or undecided, so the designer's recommendation is in use until it is reviewed. Deferred: to be settled at a later stage. Proposed: recommended, awaiting a decision. Open: no recommendation yet.

Approved, adopted and provisional

ID	Date	Decision	Status	Basis	Materials affected
DL-001	Before 10 Nov 2026	The student course runs for 20 teaching days over four weeks, Monday to Friday	Approved	Course director	Calendar; all day-wise material
DL-002	Before 10 Nov 2026	Two hours of live teaching per day, 40 hours in total	Approved	Course director	Session plans; PPT blueprints
DL-003	Before 10 Nov 2026	Format: live teaching, daily group activities and individual workbook application	Approved	Course director	Session plans; activity bank; workbooks
DL-004	Before 10 Nov 2026	Participants select their own Indian policy cases	Approved	Course director	Case Approval Form; feasibility rubric
DL-005	Before 10 Nov 2026	Learning model: live group problem-solving with individual submissions	Approved	Course director	Pods; assessment

ID	Date	Decision	Status	Basis	Materials affected
DL-006	Before 10 Nov 2026	Assessment: individual workbooks and a final group presentation. Weights provisional: workbooks 35, research and evidence 15, group work and peer review 10, individual report 20, presentation and defence 20	Approved in principle; weights provisional	Course director	Rubrics; capstone
DL-007	Before 10 Nov 2026	Primary training outcome: consulting and strategy problem-solving skills	Approved	Course director	Learning outcomes
DL-008	Before 10 Nov 2026	Identity: intellectual depth combined with consulting-style execution	Approved	Course director	Concept note; all materials
DL-009	Before 10 Nov 2026	Working title: Policy & Strategy Lab	Adopted	Master project brief	Branding; certificate
DL-010	Before 10 Nov 2026	The McKinsey seven-step process is the organising spine	Adopted	Master project brief	Curriculum
DL-011	Before 10 Nov 2026	Visual identity: white backgrounds; navy #123B63, strategy blue #2F5F8F, accent #4D82B8, pale blue #EAF1F7, text #202B36, secondary text #667482, rules #D7E0E8; Aptos with Arial fallback; 16:9; dot-and-dash markers; no stock imagery, gradients or decorative icons	Adopted	Master project brief, Part XI	All PPTs and workbooks
DL-012	Before 10 Nov 2026	Citation style: Chicago Notes and Bibliography for academic material	Adopted	Master project brief	Readings; instructor notes; source register
DL-013	Before 10 Nov 2026	Writing standard: no em dashes; no generic filler; British spelling	Adopted (British spelling proposed, in use)	Master project brief	All documents
DL-014	Before 10 Nov 2026	Production runs in twelve stages; no PPTs before the intellectual architecture is settled	Adopted	Master project brief	Production plan
DL-015	10 Nov 2026	Primary audience: final-year undergraduates, postgraduates and early-career professionals (up to about three years), with an entry diagnostic for placement	Provisional	Course director: "you see" (left to designer)	Learning outcomes; session pitch; publicity

ID	Date	Decision	Status	Basis	Materials affected
DL-016	10 Nov 2026	One anchor tool per day, at most two supporting tools demonstrated; revised 20-day architecture accepted in principle	Provisional; review at Stage 4	Course director undecided; designer's recommendation (Concept Note R1, 16.2)	Curriculum; framework library; PPTs
DL-017	10 Nov 2026	Every case names a decision-making role and the decision it faces. The client is a role (for example, a District Education Officer); participants never contact the office	Provisional; review after Stage 2	Course director undecided; designer's recommendation (Concept Note R4)	Case Approval Form; LO1; report format
DL-018	10 Nov 2026	Completion and distinction standard	Deferred to Stage 8. Working assumption for writing indicators: Working level in all domains	Course director: "we will see"	Rubrics; certificate
DL-019	10 Nov 2026	No primary research. All evidence is published or publicly available; no interviews, surveys or observation	Approved (interpreted from "No"; confirm if interviews were meant to be required instead)	Course director	Day 13; LO6; competency E5; ethics norms
DL-020	10 Nov 2026	Capstone format: client report due 72 hours after Day 20; full deck submitted; five-slide, six-minute presentation; six-minute individual defence; 500-word sealed-answer reflection	Approved	Course director	Capstone; Day 19 and 20 plans; rubrics

Adopted provisionally to build the full course (11 Nov 2026)

The course director asked for the complete course to be built ("krde pura course") and for every deliverable as Word, PDF or PowerPoint. The open recommendations below were adopted provisionally so that the materials could be produced. Each can be reversed; the materials affected are listed.

ID	Decision	Status	Materials affected
DL-021	Deliverables are Word, PDF and PowerPoint files, not web pages	Approved by the course director	All
DL-022	Arial is used in all delivered files (the brief's stated fallback), because Aptos is missing from older Office versions and cannot be checked when files are built	Adopted	All PPTs and documents
DL-023	Cohort designed for 16 (four pods of four); 12 to 16 recommended for the first run (was P-07)	Provisional	Day 20 plan; Capstone Guide; Assessment Handbook
DL-024	Delivery designed for in-person sessions; activities can run online with breakout rooms and a shared whiteboard (was P-08)	Provisional	Activity Bank; Instructor Guide
DL-025	Day 20 panel: one instructor plus two guest panellists; participants from other pods play the citizen representative (was P-09)	Provisional	Capstone Guide

ID	Decision	Status	Materials affected
DL-026	Pods: same state or city, different problems, where cohort composition allows (was P-10)	Provisional	Participant Handbook
DL-027	Spine case: Madhyapur, a stylised city, on household waste segregation; illustrative figures only (was P-11)	Provisional	All day decks; Instructor Guide; workbooks; Spine Case
DL-028	Gates are formative; the portfolio is marked once with credit for revision (was P-12)	Provisional	Assessment Handbook
DL-029	Free tools (Google Docs, Sheets, Slides) are sufficient; templates are supplied in Word and PowerPoint (was P-13)	Provisional	Workbooks
DL-030	A pre-course week with case shortlist, entry diagnostic and spreadsheet primer (was P-14)	Provisional	Calendar; Participant Handbook
DL-031	Evidence register is a distinct 15 per cent component; presentation and defence split 15 individual and 5 pod synthesis (was P-15, P-16)	Provisional	Assessment Handbook
DL-032	Ten workbooks aligned to the gates, with worksheets numbered by workbook (was P-17)	Provisional	Workbooks
DL-033	Rubrics score at domain level; competency IDs point feedback (was P-18)	Provisional	Assessment Handbook
DL-034	A pod-checked review of the options appraisal on Day 17 (was P-19)	Provisional	Day 17; Assessment Handbook

Still open

ID	Decision	Where it is decided
DL-018	Completion and distinction standard (three options ready in the Assessment Handbook)	Before the first cohort
DL-016, DL-017	Anchor-tool rule and named client role, adopted provisionally; review after the pilot	After the pilot